

iQOO Z9X 5G

A safe approach

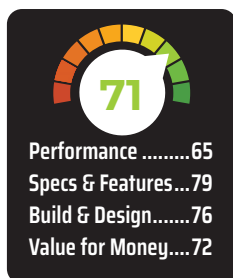
iQOO has pulled another iQOO. The brand has launched the iQOO Z9X, which is like a toned-down version of the already affordable iQOO Z9. While I was reviewing the iQOO Z9X, I was under the impression that this would be launched in a range of under ₹15,000. However, iQOO launched the smartphone for a starting price of under ₹12,000 which is outstanding given how this smartphone performs.

There isn't much to talk about in terms of offering something different, something unique. There are a lot of things that are borrowed from the older sibling, the iQOO Z9 so there isn't anything too exciting. What is exciting is that for those who want a performance and gaming-oriented DNA on a budget, the iQOO Z9X offers that in a very complete package. Let's take a look.

DESIGN

Starting with the design, the iQOO Z9X 5G comes with a similar shape and size as the iQOO Z9X. We get the same brushed green back panel with strokes of green on the matte plastic that become more and more prominent each time we throw light on them. Then there is the camera module, which reminds me of the camera module of the iQOO 12. Although it is different from the flagship, there is a little bit of hint of the iQOO 12 camera module.

Other than that, it is our basic glass slab design with flat edges. We get the USB type-C port along with the 3.5mm headphone jack and the speaker grille at the bottom. The volume rockers and power button are placed on the right side of the



frame, with the fingerprint sensor integrated into the power button itself.

With the iQOO Z9X 5G, we also get an IP64 rating which is great for a budget segment. Apart from that, things are simple and familiar with the hole-punch display and a slight chin at the bottom of the display. So in terms of design, iQOO has taken a safe approach. The iQOO Z9X 5G looks very plain and simple and there is no distinctive factor about the design except maybe the brushed green back panel or the camera module, both of which remind me of an older iQOO device.

DISPLAY

Coming to the display, this comes with an FHD+ IPS LCD display with a 120Hz refresh rate. The display is decent for the price. Under a ₹12,000 price tag, this is one of the highest-specced displays we are getting which I will always appreciate.

Coming to how it performs, with an FHD+ resolution, the details are sharp and there are no rough edges as far as

a standard user is concerned. Furthermore, given that this is an IPS LCD display, the viewing angles are also fine and you can use the iQOO Z9X 5G at a tilted angle with no issues at all.

The display is also super responsive and bright. Of course, given the 120Hz refresh rate, this display is refreshing 120 times each second so every movement every animation is as smooth as it can be. Peak brightness is claimed to be 1,000 nits which is the number for the brightest one percent of the display. I tested the real-world brightness of the whole display and under bright sunlight, the iQOO Z9X 5G showcased a maximum luminance of 868 nits and a minimum luminance of 7 nits. This is a pretty decent number and is pretty close to the claimed brightness.

So this display is decent. The colours seem a bit dull given the IPS LCD panel but that is something a reviewer like myself would notice given all the AMOLED panels we are always surrounded by. There are different colour profiles to choose from so if you like a more vibrant or saturated display, then the iQOO Z9X also offers that.

PERFORMANCE

Coming to performance, the iQOO Z9X 5G is powered by the now popular Qualcomm Snapdragon 6 Gen 1 SoC paired with up to 8GB of RAM and 128GB of internal storage. We also get a microSD card slot for expandable storage so if 128GB is less for you, there is the option to expand storage.

Coming to how the smartphone performs, in day-to-day usage it is very good. The smartphone doesn't slow down while doing normal tasks like social media or texting. The Snapdragon 6 Gen 1 chip has enough juice to handle the basic tasks with ease. Even multi-tasking, for that matter, is smooth on this smartphone. Coming to numbers, in benchmarks the iQOO Z9X 5G didn't outperform every competitor as some would have expected an iQOO smartphone to. However, it didn't disappoint either.